

What is a dinosaur?

Two legs or four?

Meat-eater or plant-eater? What made a dinosaur? They all had four limbs, though many walked on two. There were a number of other features they had in common.

Long tails

Scientists believe dinosaurs held their tails above the ground as there is no evidence of drag marks when trackways have been found.

Giganotosaurus

Scaly skin

Impressions of dinosaur skin are rare, but palaeontologists (scientists who study fossils) have found enough to know that dinosaurs had scaly skin, rather like crocodiles today.

Meat-eating dinosaurs were known as theropods.

Cold-blooded lizards have to warm up in sunlight; they cannot control their temperature.

Were dinosaurs warm-blooded?

It's possible that meat-eating dinosaurs were warm-blooded (like we are), while plant-eating sauropods were cold-blooded. Warm-blooded animals use food as fuel to stay warm. Sauropods were too large to have eaten enough plants to do this.

All dinosaurs lived on land. They could not fly or swim.